Observation Sheet

A record for one bounded place, plot or observation frame. The eight categories are a land-based starter grammar, not universal indicators or a score. Adapt, replace or leave them unused through local knowledge. Format 2 v1.3.3 · 24 October 2026 · Candidate tool.

Place / frame / privacy code:

Date / time / duration:

Weather / conditions:

Observer:

Describe before interpreting. Record what was directly noticed and the effort or conditions of observation. No category is inherently good or bad outside its ecological, cultural and practical context.

Species: possible identification is not confirmation. “Not observed” is not proof of absence. Use N/A when a prompt does not apply, and Unknown when it applies but the basis is insufficient.

1 Surface and soil cover

What covers the surface, and where?

Optional descriptive cue:
covered · partial · bare · N/A / unknown

2 Vegetation structure

What layers or patterns are present?

Optional descriptive cue:
layered · mixed · single layer · N/A / unknown

3 Water behaviour

Where does water move, remain or enter the soil?

Optional descriptive cue:
infiltrates · pools / holds · runs off · N/A / unknown

4 Change and succession

What appears to establish, hold, decline or reset?

Optional descriptive cue:
establishing · holding · declining / resetting · N/A / unknown

5 Species and signs

What organisms or signs were observed?

Optional descriptive cue:
observed · possible ID · not observed · N/A / unknown

6 Soil signals

What did you notice in smell, texture, roots or organisms?

Optional descriptive cue:
active signs · mixed · compacted · N/A · unknown

7 Organic matter

What organic matter is produced, moved, returned or removed?

Optional descriptive cue:
returned · moved / retained · removed · N/A / unknown

8 Human rhythm

What did the work require from the people carrying it?

Optional descriptive cue:
carried · strained · not sustainable · N/A / unknown

NOTES Keep different kinds of knowing separately readable

Direct observation / measurement and method

Lived experience / local knowledge and whose

Interpretation / working hypothesis / confidence

Source, photo or specimen reference / what remains unknown

Remember: Identification remains corrigible; check lookalikes and relevant local knowledge. Protect sensitive species, places and people. Share local knowledge only with consent. A blank or uncertainty is useful evidence of the limits of this visit.

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What did this visit make possible to notice?